

ORDANA

Stars: Blue Giant / White Dwarf

Known for: Factories of the Ayuini Cartel, Trade on Hayrangi Station, Rebels of the Ayuttha Leopards

Exports: Xenon, drugs, food, weapons

Imports: Starcraft parts, high technology

Ordana is often called the Zenithian powerbase in the Quadrant of the Pillar. This is especially true now that the system has become a natural trade path to Mira on the new Odacon Route – a result of the frequent blockades of Zalos. The system is not free from conflict, however, as a growing rebel movement called Ayuttha's Leopards fight against the allies of the Consortium.

OVERVIEW

Ordana is a system with two stars, Ordana and Yuisin. Merchants passing through the Quadrant of the Pillar tend to travel via Ordana rather than the inhospitable Sivas system. Since the Draconites has made the Altai system a base for the Firstcome (at least in the eyes of the Zenthians), Ordana has become the obvious choice for Zenithian organizations to establish themselves.

Many of the events in the system's history are related to its main planet, Ordana. This is home to the Ayuini Cartel – but also to the cartel's adversaries, the Hayrangi Group and its dignitaries. During the last cycle, Ordana saw the birth of a growing rebel movement: the People's Army of Ordana, also known as Ayuttha's Leopards. The rebels are tired of the Ayuini Cartel's manipulation of the economy and they believe taking up arms is the only way forward.

The Ayuini Cartel has responded by recruiting more soldiers to its ranks, and it's expected that the central planet of the system will soon be wrought in the flames of war.

THE UNCOMELY BROTHER

Yuisin have often been described either as "the uncomely brother" or "the inept sister", as the system is underdeveloped and lawless. The only destination that draws visitors is the Palace of the Slumbering Prophet.

The system has recently witnessed a surge in colonization thanks to the discovery of large deposits of Xenon. The Ayuini Cartel in Ordana – afraid of losing its newfound power – is doing its best to undermine the colonization effort, which has resulted in unrest in the neighboring system. Yuisin is home to many loosely formed power coalitions in Yuisin. These try to keep the peace, but internal and external conflicts have plunged the system into anarchy.

NEIGHBORS

Altai: The political and social (but not the military or religious) center of the Third Horizon.

Zhau: Home of some of the most influential nomad clans in the Third Horizon. Rumored to have a portal to the Fourth Horizon.

HISTORY

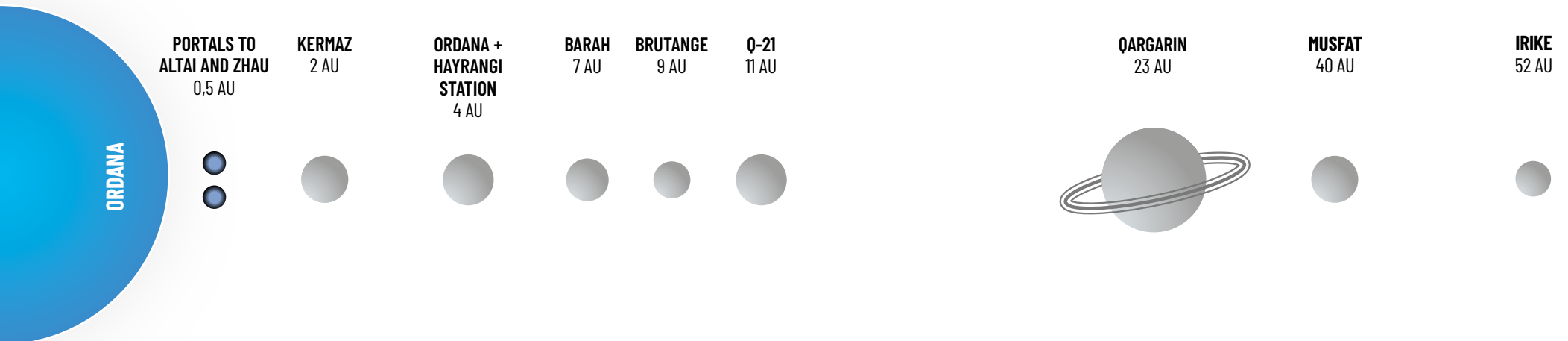
THE TAO

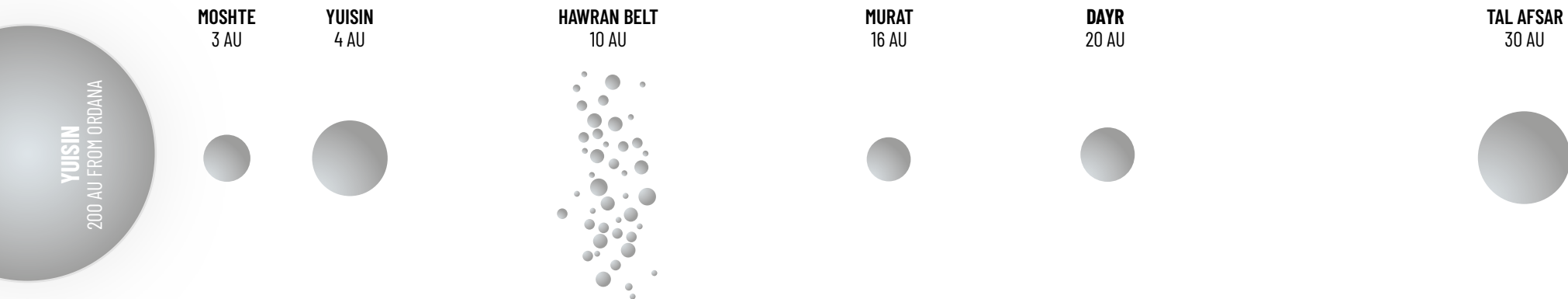
The people of Ordana may seem fractured but they share a common, if cryptic, history. The majority of the planet's

inhabitants call themselves "Tao", and are said to share a common ancestor: The Tao family. The identity of this family has been lost in the shroud of history, but its impact on the planet Ordana is without question. Traces of the Tao family can be found all over the planet – from artifacts washed ashore on the banks of the Ayuini River to statues buried in the mineral rich soil of the Meng Delta. The most prominent trace, of course, is the abandoned city of Ayuttha, deep within the delta. The cause of the Tao family's decline – and the reasons that its daughters and sons abandoned the civilization they created – remains an enigma to this day. The mysterious city has lent its name to the People's Army of Ordana.

THE ATAMANS

The other major group inhabiting the planet is the Atamans of the Plain of Ordos. The Atamans are divided into closely knit clans who can trace their lineage back to the first colonizers of Ordana. In the time before the isolating aftermath of the First Portal War, it was not uncommon for strife to erupt between the clans, and the plains were washed red with blood from countless onslaughts. For a time it seemed as if the people of the grasslands stood at the brink of annihilation. Then, the three largest clans formed a truce to secure the future of Ordos. They elected a mutual arbiter, the Ataman – a magistrate that all the clans could turn to during times of turmoil. The autonomy of the clans was kept sacred but larger disputes were always decided by this impartial judge.





THE PEOPLE'S ARMY OF ORDANA

The People's Army of Ordana has established a strong base in the Meng Delta among small clusters of smuggler hideouts. Minor skirmishes between Cartel forces and rebel fighters occur daily, but these have yet to break out into open warfare. The hostile environment of the Delta has proven to be hard to conquer, and the Cartel forces struggle not only with the rebels, but also with the very forces of nature. The airspace over the Delta is under constant surveillance in an attempt to suppress rebel activity. The Legion has provided aerial support in the form of a wing of Orcinus Strikecraft, flown by pilots from the Cartel's own flight academy.

ORDANA SYSTEM

Kermaz: Deserted planet

Ordana: System hub, home of the Ayuvin Cartel

Hayrangi: Space station controlled by The Hayrangi Group

Barah: Desert planet, home to the crimson temple Sul-Ardike. Known for extreme climate differences.

Brutange: Uninhabitable due to an infectious pandemic.

O-21: Known for the moon Bochin with its many lakes.

Qargarin: Gas giant with more than 20 rings containing several unattended temples to the Icons.

Musfat: Contains rich Boronium deposits but no larger colonies.

Irike: A lonely planet which is said to slowly spin out of the system.

ORDANA (PLANET)

The planet Ordana is almost entirely covered by polar ice caps. These extend from both poles almost to the planet's midsection. The equator is home to both settlers and indigenous tribes. The

equatorial regions contain enormous swamps, windswept moors, and an almost inaccessible mountain chain. The most significant hub is the expanding industrial city of Ayuvin, which houses the planet's most influential organisation – the Ayuvin Cartel.

THE MENG DELTA

The mighty Meng Delta is situated where the Sie River meets. expanding space trade of the Horizon. Several independent scientists have studied Banzin. They claim the plant still seems to be in a trial phase. The Ayuvin Cartel disputes these claims. However, the plant has been blamed for a recent outbreak of a fungal infection in the Delta, which has destroyed crops of indigenous rice and made farmlands barren for an unforeseeable future.

HAYRANGI

The star system's largest space station is Hayrangi, home of the Hayrangi Group. The financial collective is viewed as the primary competitor of the city of Ayuvin and the Cartel, and have clashed with the two on multiple occasions. The Hayrangi Group has well established trade contracts with the Mogul clan Nasr-Jang, which has earned the group a respected status within the entire Ordana system. The group has, despite its mixed interests, invested sizable sums in Yuisin and the growing Xenon trade.

Hayrangi takes the shape of two starfishes mounted on top of each other, rotating in opposite directions. The station is officially owned by the brothers Auros and Moro Jafar, who with their splendid pragmatism have endeavored to make the station seem like a neutral site. Their politics annoy the Ayuvin Cartel but not the Consortium. The reason behind the Consortium's placidness is that Hayrangi is the only place in the Quadrant of the Pillar where the

Consortium and the Moguls can practice commerce, albeit with assistance from the financial group's envoys. The station's security is run by the mercenary unit, the Crimson Tigers, which has its headquarters there. The Tigers operate not only throughout the Quadrant but also beyond – for example, in the Rimward Reach and on Mira.

YUISIN SYSTEM

Moshte: Torrid gravel planet with forgotten humanites.

Yuisin: Here lies the palace of the Slumbering Prophet.

Hawran Belt: A wide asteroid field.

Murat: Home to the space station Yuisin-3, a water hole belonging to the Lyricum Triade.

Dayr: Rocky planet with three sacred moons.

Tal Afsar: Gigantic ice planet with the system's largest Xenon eposits.

